

Peter Johnston, PhD

PROJECT & OPERATIONS COORDINATOR – AEC · OFFICE TECHNOLOGY

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Construction project coordinator with a research scientist's rigor and a builder's instinct for process improvement. I coordinate subcontractors, suppliers, materials procurement, scheduling, and client communication across dozens of concurrent jobs in the insurance-restoration and custom-build space — and I build the systems that make that coordination faster and more accurate. I pair advanced spreadsheet and document-automation skills with AI-assisted tooling to turn repetitive tasks into reliable systems, comfortable both running an AEC office day to day and improving the technology that runs it.

■ CORE COMPETENCIES

OPERATIONS & COORDINATION

Project coordination across concurrent jobs
· subcontractor & vendor coordination ·
materials procurement and order tracking ·
scheduling and milestone management ·
records management and document control
· client communication.

DOCUMENTATION & PRODUCTIVITY

Advanced spreadsheet modeling (formulas, pivots, cost & markup analysis, data validation, external data connections) ·
templated document generation · database creation & reporting · Google Workspace power user (Sheets, Docs, Apps Script) and equivalent MS Office workflows · Adobe Creative Cloud (20+ years).

PROCESS IMPROVEMENT & AUTOMATION

Spotting manual bottlenecks and building systems to remove them · workflow design · document-generation automation · procurement reconciliation · AI-assisted tool development · self-directed process projects from idea to rollout.

INDUSTRY KNOWLEDGE

Insurance restoration · subcontractor scoping & competitive bidding · finishing-materials selection and allowances · Xactimate estimate workflows · construction procurement and supplier relationships.

■ EXPERIENCE

Grey Wolfe Construction — Project Coordinator

Jan 2026 – Present · Seattle, WA

Coordinate insurance-restoration and custom-build projects end to end while continuously building the internal systems that run the office.

- Coordinate dozens of concurrent construction projects — subcontractor and supplier coordination, scheduling, materials procurement, document control, and client communication.
- Led the design and rollout of the company's project-tracking system: a suite of six connected applications that replaced scattered spreadsheets with a single live source of truth for job status, schedules, and materials — used daily by field crews, the warehouse, and office staff.
- Automated the office's document production — finishing-materials selection letters, subcontractor scope-of-work and competitive-bid packages, supplier quote requests, and client letters generated directly from job data — cutting routine paperwork from hours to minutes.
- Built a procurement reconciliation dashboard that matches supplier orders against deliveries and flags discrepancies and outstanding materials by dollar value, tightening cost control across active jobs.
- Standardized subcontractor scoping and competitive bidding across trades (electrical, plumbing, flooring, gutters, roofing, and more), with margin targets built into the cost analysis.

Freelance Administrative Consultant

2020 - Present · Seattle, WA

Developed office solutions while expanding technical expertise through self-directed learning and real-world projects.

- Created dynamic spreadsheets connecting to external data sources, eliminating manual data entry.
- Built custom expense-tracking and reporting systems using Google Apps Script.
- Designed and produced a professional 28-page monthly newsletter reaching 1,000+ readers.
- Developed web-based tools for data collection and organization for nonprofit organizations.

Grace Connection Services — Executive Assistant

Sep - Oct 2024 · Marysville, WA

- Provided administrative support to executive leadership; managed complex schedules and stakeholder communications.
- Created digital expense-tracking systems in Google Sheets; managed payroll and authored training SOPs.

Amazon — Classification Specialist

2017 - 2018 · Seattle, WA

- Managed complex product-classification databases; developed search logic for hazardous-materials classification.
- Created SQL queries for data retrieval and reporting; built tracking systems to monitor classification accuracy; advised on DOT/GHS compliance.

HMS Productions — Technical Designer

1995 - 2004 · New York, NY

- Created print catalogs, marketing materials, and early web graphics for fashion-industry clients on tight deadlines.

Community Service Roles

2024 - 2025 · Seattle, WA

- Newsletter Editor (Seattle Intergroup) · Web Developer (Hunger Intervention Program — WordPress redesign + web-enabled cold-storage sensors) · Driver (Operation Nightwatch) · meal service (Senior Meals Program).

■ EDUCATION

- **B.S. Software Engineering** — Arizona State University (*in progress*)
- **Ph.D. Chemistry** — University of Washington, 2016

- **McIntyre Scholar** — Western Washington University, 2008 (100% tuition scholarship)

■ RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

11 peer-reviewed publications · 356 citations · h-index 6, in organic electro-optic materials & silicon/plasmonic photonics (2014–2017). Ph.D. research in the Dalton group at the University of Washington. Full profile on [Google Scholar](#).

1. Plasmonic modulators for microwave photonics applications. *Asia Communications and Photonics Conference (ACP)*, 2017.
2. Structure–function relationship exploration for enhanced thermal stability and electro-optic activity in monolithic organic NLO chromophores. *Journal of Materials Chemistry C* 4(15), 3119–3124, 2016.
3. Plasmonic phased array feeder enabling ultra-fast beam steering at millimeter waves. *Optics Express* 24(22), 25608–25618, 2016.
4. Direct RF-to-optical detection by a plasmonic modulator integrated into a four-leaf-clover antenna. *Conference on Lasers and Electro-Optics (CLEO)*, 2016.
5. Microwave plasmonics: a novel platform for RF photonics. *IEEE International Topical Meeting on Microwave Photonics (MWP)*, 259–262, 2016.
6. Optimizing plasmonic modulators for in-device nonlinearities of up to 275 pm/V. *Integrated Photonics Research, Silicon and Nanophotonics (IPR)*, ITu1A.1, 2016.
7. Plasmonic phased array feeder enabling symbol-by-symbol mm-wave beam steering at 60 GHz. *IEEE International Topical Meeting on Microwave Photonics (MWP)*, 43–46, 2016.
8. Structure–function paradigms of organic electro-optic materials. *Ph.D. dissertation, University of Washington*, 2016.
9. 40 GBd 16QAM signaling at 160 Gb/s in a silicon-organic hybrid modulator. *Journal of Lightwave Technology* 33(6), 1210–1216, 2015.
10. Benzocyclobutene barrier layer for suppressing conductance in nonlinear optical devices during electric field poling. *Applied Physics Letters* 104(24), 243304, 2014.
11. 40 GBd 16QAM modulation at 160 Gbit/s in a silicon-organic hybrid (SOH) modulator. *European Conference on Optical Communication (ECOC)*, 2014.

■ BUILT IN PUBLIC

The systems thinking above isn't just on the job — these are live, open-source tools I build and run. Working proof, one click away.

Nonprofit Search

Look up any U.S. nonprofit's mission, Form 990 financials, and efficiency metrics.

Form 990

Data

Grants Visualizer

Interactive map of how grant funding moves between organizations, grantor to grantee.

Viz

D3

Technical Blog

Field notes on nonprofit data, automation, security, and the command line — built-time TikZ and all.

Haskell

Writing

github.com/noprofits-org

The source behind it all — a serverless CORS proxy, the apps above, and more.

Open source

Serverless